



C#

Level 1

TabControl



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Definition

TabControl

 Windows Forms control used to organize multiple pages inside the same form.

 Each page is represented by a `TabPage`, and the user switches between pages by selecting a tab.

Explanation

TabPage Organization

 Each TabPage represents one section of the form and can contain controls such as Label, TextBox, Button, or DataGridView.

Tab Selection

 SelectedIndex gets or sets the index of the selected tab.

 SelectedTab gets or sets the currently selected TabPage.

Tab Appearance

 Alignment determines where the tabs appear.

 Appearance, Multiline, ItemSize, and SizeMode control how the tabs are displayed.

Procedure

1. Add a TabControl to the form.
2. Add the required TabPages.
3. Set the Text property of each TabPage.
4. Add controls to the appropriate TabPage.
5. Use SelectedIndex or SelectedTab to access the selected page.
6. Handle SelectedIndexChanged when the selected tab changes.

💡 Example

```
TabControl tabControl = new TabControl();  
TabPage tabPage1 = new TabPage("Personal Information");  
TabPage tabPage2 = new TabPage("Contact Information");  
tabControl.TabPages.Add(tabPage1);  
tabControl.TabPages.Add(tabPage2);
```

➡ Result

[Personal Information] [Contact Information]

Note

- ◆ `TabPage` contains all pages inside the `TabControl`.
- ◆ `SelectedIndex` represents the selected tab by its index.
- ◆ `SelectedTab` represents the selected `TabPage`.
- ◆ `Alignment` can be `Top`, `Bottom`, `Left`, or `Right`.
- ◆ `SizeMode` can be `Normal`, `FillToRight`, or `Fixed`.



Comparison

TabControl

- ✓ Contains and manages multiple TabPages.
- ✓ Allows switching between pages.
- ✓ Provides tab-related properties and events.

TabPage

- ✓ Represents one page inside a TabControl.
- ✓ Contains the controls belonging to that page.
- ✓ Uses Text to define the displayed tab name.

⊘ Warning

- ◆ Controls should be added to a `TabPage`, not directly to the `TabControl`.
- ◆ `TabControl` manages the pages, while each `TabPage` manages the controls inside that page.

✦ Summary

- ✓ TabControl → manages multiple pages.
- ✓ TabPage → represents one page/tab.
- ✓ TabPages → collection of pages.
- ✓ SelectedIndex → selected tab index.
- ✓ SelectedTab → selected page.
- ✓ SelectedIndexChanged → detects tab changes.

Thank you 😊